

Subject: Invitation to Contribute to the Journal of Basic and Applied Zoology – Special Collection on “Ethics and Animal Welfare”

Dear Colleague,

I am delighted to invite you to contribute a scholarly manuscript to a forthcoming collection of the Journal of Basic and Applied Zoology, published by Springer Nature, dedicated to the important and increasingly consequential theme of: “Ethics and Animal Welfare”

I have the privilege of serving as Guest Editor for this collection, and I would be particularly pleased to see contributions from colleagues whose research, teaching, clinical, regulatory or professional activities intersect with animal welfare, zoological sciences, biomedical research, veterinary medicine, conservation, laboratory animal science, wildlife management, animal ethics and related disciplines.

The ethical treatment and welfare of animals have become an essential dimension of contemporary zoological and biological sciences. Increasing scientific, public and regulatory attention is being directed towards how animals are used in research, education, testing, conservation, agriculture, wildlife management and other scientific or societal activities. These developments require continued scholarly dialogue that brings together scientific evidence, ethical principles, animal welfare science, professional practice and appropriate regulatory frameworks.

This collection provides an opportunity for researchers and practitioners to contribute to that dialogue and to examine how scientific advancement can be reconciled with responsible, humane and evidence-based care and use of animals. Suggested areas of contribution

Contributions may address, but are not limited to:

- Ethical principles governing animal use in science and research;
- Animal welfare science and contemporary welfare assessment;
- The 3Rs—Replacement, Reduction and Refinement;
- Laboratory animal welfare and laboratory animal medicine;
- Ethics of biomedical and translational research involving animals;
- Institutional animal care and use committees and ethical review;
- Veterinary oversight and professional responsibilities;
- Pain, suffering, distress and humane endpoints;
- Refinement of experimental procedures and husbandry practices;
- Ethics of wildlife research, conservation and management;
- Zoo and captive-animal welfare;
- Ethics and welfare in zoological research and education;
- Animal welfare legislation, policy and regulatory systems;
- Responsible conduct of research involving animals;
- Cultural, philosophical and societal perspectives on animal ethics;
- One Health, One Welfare and the human–animal–environment interface;
- Emerging technologies and alternatives to animal experimentation;
- Artificial intelligence, computational approaches and the future of animal-based research;
- Capacity development and animal-welfare education;
- Animal welfare challenges in low- and middle-income countries;

- Animal welfare and scientific research in Africa and other developing regions;
- Harmonisation of international standards and good practice;
- Ethics, animal welfare and the Sustainable Development Goals.

We particularly welcome evidence-based original research, systematic or critical reviews, methodological contributions and scholarly perspectives that advance understanding or practice in ethics and animal welfare within the broad scope of zoological and biological sciences.

An opportunity for African and international scholarship

I would especially encourage colleagues working in Africa and other emerging research environments to consider contributing. There is considerable scope for strengthening the visibility of research addressing animal welfare, ethical review, laboratory animal science, wildlife and conservation practice, veterinary care and responsible research within these settings.

The collection aims to provide an international scholarly forum in which evidence and experiences from different geographical, institutional and cultural contexts can contribute to the global discussion on responsible animal care and use.

Submission deadline: 22 April 2027

If this theme aligns with your research interests, I warmly encourage you to consider preparing and submitting a manuscript for consideration.

Further information concerning the collection and submission process is available through the Springer Nature collection page: Journal of Basic and Applied Zoology – Ethics and Animal Welfare Collection

Please consult the journal and collection information carefully for the applicable manuscript requirements, submission procedures and editorial criteria.

I would be grateful if you would also share this invitation with colleagues, research groups, postgraduate students and professional networks who may have relevant work to contribute.

I very much look forward to receiving your scholarly contributions and to creating, together with colleagues across the international scientific community, a substantive collection that advances ethical reflection, scientific rigour and humane animal welfare practice.

With warm regards and best wishes for your research,

Professor Francis-Adelade G.O. Fakoya, MBCHB, MSc, PhD, FHEA.

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I look forward to your contribution to this important scholarly conversation.